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The ICC has said Bangladesh will not face punishment for refusing to play its 2026 T20 World Cup matches in India, a decision that led to its exclusion from the tournament. The board also confirmed that Bangladesh will be awarded an ICC event before the 2031 men's ODI World Cup, which it is set to co-host with India. "It is agreed that no financial, sporting or administrative penalty will be imposed on Bangladesh Cricket Board in relation to the current matter," the ICC said in a statement. "As part of this understanding, an agreement has been reached that Bangladesh will host an ICC event prior to the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2031, subject to the usual ICC hosting processes, timelines and operational requirements."

REUTERS



2

England completed a 3-0 T20I series clean sweep over Sri Lanka in early February 2026, sealing the final match in Pallekele by 12 runs despite being bowled out for 128. Jacob Bethell (4-11) and Will Jacks (3-14) led a superb bowling effort to defend the modest total, as England fine-tuned its preparations for the 2026 T20 World Cup.

REUTERS



3

Pakistan swept Australia 3-0 in the three-match T20I series in Lahore, capping it with a dominant 111-run win in the final game on February 1. Pakistan posted 207-6 before Mohammad Nawaz's 5-18 skittled Australia for 96, handing it its biggest defeat in T20I cricket.



4

Global investors, including Manchester United co-owner Avram Glazer (**in front**), are exploring bids of more than \$1 billion to buy the Royal Challengers Bengaluru (RCB) and Rajasthan Royals (RR) franchises. The valuation for each team is expected to be close to, or even exceed, the combined price of the Lucknow and Ahmedabad IPL franchises, which the BCCI sold in 2021 for a total of Rs. 12,715 crore (about \$1.69 billion).

AFP



5

Australia pacer Josh Hazlewood has been ruled out of the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 in Sri Lanka and India after running out of time to regain full fitness for the latter stages of the tournament. Australia will not name a replacement immediately, with selectors choosing instead to reassess based on conditions and squad requirements as the event progresses.

REUTERS